

standard of living. The parents of Ms. BPF have failed to obtain their objective. Their goal was to have a daughter who would “never have to worry.” But the method they used yielded just the opposite result. People often attempt to shelter their children from the economic realities of life. But such shelters often produce adults who are in constant fear of tomorrow.

## **THE PRODUCTS OF ZERO EOC**

How valuable is your signature? It depends on how it is used. A signature helped Paul Orfalea start the business that bears his nickname —Kinko’s.

*With a \$5,000 loan ... co-signed by his father in 1969 ... [he] rented a small garage.... From there he and a few friends sold about \$2,000 worth [of services] ... daily (Laurie. Flynn, “Kinko’s Adds Internet Services to Its Copying Business,” The New York Times, March 19, 1996, p. C5).*

It is estimated that Kinko’s has annual sales in excess of \$600 million. But what if Mr. Orfalea’s parents had socialized their son in an environment similar to Ms. BPF’s? Would he be as productive today? It’s very unlikely. Mr. Orfalea has what all successful business owners possess: considerable courage. Taking financial risk is evidence of courage. But what risk has Ms. BPF ever taken? Very little.

*Webster’s* defines *courage* as “mental or moral strength to resist opposition, danger, or hardship.” It implies firmness of mind and will in the face of danger or extreme difficulty. Courage can be developed. *But it cannot be nurtured in an environment that eliminates all risks, all difficulty, all dangers.* That is precisely why Ms. BPF lacks the courage to leave home, expand her business, and wean herself from heavy doses of economic inpatient care.

It takes considerable courage to work in an environment in which one is compensated according to one’s performance. Most affluent people have courage. What evidence supports this statement? Most affluent people in America are either business owners or employees who are paid